

Password and MFA Policy

Document ID	NCS-IAM-002
Owner	Identity & Access Management
Version	3.0
Effective date	2026-08-15
Classification	Internal

1. Password Requirements

Corporate passwords must contain at least 14 characters. Passphrases are recommended. Passwords must not contain the employee name, company name, username, or common breached-password patterns.

Routine password rotation is not required for standard users. A password must be changed immediately when compromise is suspected, after an administrator-directed reset, or when a credential is found in a breach notification.

2. Password Reset

Users who can still authenticate must reset their password through the Self-Service Access Portal. Users who are locked out must contact the IT Service Desk after identity verification.

After a confirmed compromise, the user must reset the password, revoke active sessions, review MFA methods, and report suspicious sign-ins.

3. Multi-Factor Authentication

MFA is required for VPN, cloud consoles, source-code repositories, privileged roles, and any application classified as high impact.

The preferred MFA methods are a hardware security key or an authenticator application. SMS may only be used as a temporary recovery method when approved by the Service Desk.

Never approve an MFA request you did not initiate. Report repeated unexpected prompts immediately.

4. Service Accounts and API Credentials

Service accounts must not be used for interactive employee sign-in. API credentials must be stored in an approved secrets manager and rotated according to the owning system risk classification.

Credentials must never be committed to Git repositories, placed in Docker images, or embedded in client-side code.

5. Lockout and Recovery

Five consecutive failed sign-in attempts within 15 minutes trigger a temporary 15-minute lockout. The Service Desk may unlock an account earlier after verifying the user identity.

Privileged accounts may require Security Operations approval before unlock when suspicious activity is detected.